

TIMELINE

- **December 29, 1808** Born in Raleigh, North Carolina, the third child of stableman Jacob Johnson and his wife Mary, a weaver.
- **1812** His father dies, leaving the family in poverty. Johnson has no formal education.
- **1822** Apprenticed to a tailor.
- **1825** Runs away with his brother, William, to Greeneville, Tennessee, where Andrew finds work as a tailor.



JOHNSON'S TAILOR SHOP IN GREENEVILLE

- **1827** Marries Eliza McArdle, with whom he will have five children over the next 25 years.
- **March 4, 1843** Enters the U.S. House of Representatives as a Democrat. Over the next ten years he will serve five consecutive terms in the House.
- **October 17, 1853** Takes office as Governor of Tennessee.
- **October 8, 1857** Enters the U.S. Senate as junior senator for Tennessee. As such he argues passionately against secession.
- **March 12, 1862** President Lincoln appoints him military governor of Tennessee following Union gains there. His area of authority grows as Union armies expand their grip on the state.